UP Special Topic 6 — Society, Demographics, Tribes, Education System and Social Development

Current Affairs

Year	Fact	Why it matters
Rolling	Refresh edition-bound figures from latest Census / Survey / State CA desks.	Do not invent interim totals.

Teaching cards

2.1 Complete Demographic Analysis of Uttar Pradesh (Census 2011)

A. Population Scale & Global Position

- **Total Population**: **199,812,341** (Males: 104,480,510; Females: 95,331,831).
- Accounts for **16.51% of the total population of India**, occupying only **7.33% of India's land area**.
- **Global Context**: If Uttar Pradesh were an independent sovereign nation, it would be the **fifth most populous country in the world** (surpassing Brazil, Pakistan, Nigeria, and Bangladesh).

B. The Geometry of Demographic Extremes in UP

DISTRICT EXTREMES LEAGUE TABLE

Parameter	Highest Ranked District	Lowest Ranked District
• Population	Prayagraj (59.54 Lakh)	Mahoba (8.75 Lakh)
• Decadal Growth	GB Nagar (49.1%)	Kanpur Nagar (9.9%)
• Density	Ghaziabad (3,971 / km²)	Lalitpur (242 / km²)
• Sex Ratio	Jaunpur (1,024)	GB Nagar (851)
• Child Sex Ratio	Balrampur (950)	Baghpat (841)
• Overall Literacy	GB Nagar (80.12%)	Shravasti (46.74%)
• Male Literacy	GB Nagar (88.06%)	Shravasti (57.16%)
• Female Literacy	Kanpur Nagar (75.05%)	Shravasti (34.78%)
• Urban Population %	Ghaziabad (67.6%)	Shravasti (3.46%)
• SC Population %	Kaushambi (34.72%)	Baghpat (11.44%)
• SC Population Count	Sitapur (14.46 Lakh)	Baghpat (1.49 Lakh)
• ST Population %	Sonbhadra (20.67%)	Baghpat / Kannauj (~0.0%)
• Surface Area	Lakhimpur Kheri (7680)	Hapur (660 km²)

C. The Literacy Profile

- **Total Literacy Rate**: **67.68%** (improved from 56.27% in 2001).

- **Male Literacy**: **77.28%**; **Female Literacy**: **57.18%**.
- **Gender Literacy Gap**: **20.10%** (Male minus Female).
- **Key Trap**:
- Highest Overall Literacy = **Gautam Buddha Nagar (80.12%)**.
- Highest Female Literacy = **Kanpur Nagar (75.05%)** (followed by Lucknow at 71.53%).
- Lowest across Overall, Male, and Female = **Shravasti** (Overall 46.74%, Male 57.16%, Female 34.78%).

2.2 Scheduled Castes (SC) & Scheduled Tribes (ST) in Uttar Pradesh

A. Scheduled Caste (SC) Demographics

- Total SC Population: **4.14 Crore** (**20.69% of the state population**).
- **National Context**: Uttar Pradesh has the **highest absolute SC population of any state in India** (constituting ~20.5% of all Scheduled Castes in India). However, in terms of **percentage of state population**, **Punjab ranks #1** (31.9%), followed by Himachal Pradesh and West Bengal; UP ranks 4th by percentage.
- **Top SC Percentage Districts in UP**: 1. **Kaushambi (34.72%)** 2. Sitapur (32.26%) 3. Hardoi (31.14%) 4. Unnao (30.49%) 5. Rae Bareli (30.26%)
- **Top SC Absolute Population Districts in UP**: 1. **Sitapur (14.46 Lakh)** 2. Prayagraj (13.10 Lakh) 3. Hardoi (12.65 Lakh) 4. Azamgarh (11.72 Lakh)

B. Scheduled Tribe (ST) Demographics

- Total ST Population: **11.34 Lakh** (**0.57% of the state population**).
- Before November 2000, undivided UP had a larger tribal population in the Uttarakhand hill districts (Jaunsari, Bhotia, Tharu, Buksha, Raji).
- In 2003, the Government of India notified **10 additional tribal communities** in UP: Gond (Dhuria, Nayak, Ojha, Pathari, Rajgond), Kharwar/Khairwar, Sahariya, Parhaiya, Baiga, Pankha/Panika, Agariya, Chero, Bhuiya/Bhuinya.
- **Top ST Districts in UP**: 1. **Sonbhadra**: Accounts for **20.67% ST population** (3.85 Lakh tribals — highest both in count and percentage). 2. **Lalitpur**: 5.86% (Sahariya tribe). 3. Deoria, Ballia, Ghazipur, Varanasi (Gond and Kharwar groups).
- **Districts with negligible/nil ST population**: Baghpat, Kannauj, Jalaun, Badaun, Ayodhya.

2.3 Ethnography of Major Tribes in Uttar Pradesh

A. The Tharu Tribe

- Largest scheduled tribe in Uttar Pradesh, inhabiting the sub-Himalayan Terai forest tract of **Lakhimpur Kheri, Bahraich, Shravasti, Balrampur, and Maharajganj**.
- **Social Organization**:
- Matrilineal traditions where women hold high status; divided into endogamous sub-groups (*Batta, Rawat, Birtia, Mahto*).
- Marriage: Cross-cousin marriage and negotiation through middleman (*Mazpatia*); wedding feast is called **Lathmarva Bhoj**.

- **Distinctive Religious Rituals**:
- **Diwali as a Period of Mourning (*Shoka Parva*)**: Unlike mainstream Hindus who celebrate lights, the Tharus gather to mourn and commemorate ancestors by offering effigies and food (*Putla Vidhan / Jhad*).
- Worship *Bhumsen* (village deity) and celebrate the **Bajhar festival** with community feasts in summer.
- Traditional drink: Fermented rice liquor called **Jad** (*Jaad*).

B. The Buxa (Bhoksa) Tribe

- Concentrated in **Bijnor district** (occupying 130 villages in the Buxar forest tract).
- Claim Rajput lineage; organized into sub-castes (Buxa Rajput, Buxa Brahmin, Buxa Ahir).
- Primary deity: **Chamunda Devi** (worshipped at Kashipur).
- Practice bride-price (*Kanya Shulk*) and village council (*Biradari Panchayat*) headed by a *Takht*.

C. The Sahariya Tribe

- Inhabits the drought-prone, rocky forested terrain of **Lalitpur district** in Bundelkhand.
- Highly marginalized; dependent on forest minor produce collection, stone quarrying, and seasonal agriculture.

D. The Agariya & Baiga Tribes of Sonbhadra

- **Agariya**: Traditional indigenous iron-smelting blacksmiths who extracted iron ore from local Vindhyan rocks using clay blast furnaces.
- **Baiga**: Forest dwellers renowned for traditional botanical knowledge, herbal medicine, and acting as tribal priests (*Guniya / Pahan*).

2.4 Universities, Scientific Research and Higher Education in UP

A. Historic Central Universities

1. **University of Allahabad (1887)**: - Established on 23 September 1887; designed by Sir William Emerson. - Known as the **"Oxford of the East"**; granted Central University status in 2005.
2. **Banaras Hindu University (BHU), Varanasi (1916)**: - Established by **Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya** under the BHU Act, 1915, with support from Dr. Annie Besant (who founded the Central Hindu College in 1898) and Darbhanga/Kashi royal houses. - Largest residential university in Asia.
3. **Aligarh Muslim University (AMU), Aligarh (1920)**: - Originated as the **Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental (MAO) College** founded in **1875** by social reformer **Sir Syed Ahmad Khan** to advance modern Western scientific education among Indian Muslims. Upgraded to a Central University in 1920.

B. The Lucknow CSIR & Scientific Research Cluster

Lucknow is home to the dense concentration of national scientific laboratories: - **Central Drug Research Institute (CDRI)** (est. 1951): Pioneer in pharmacology; developed *Centchroman* (world's first non-steroidal once-a-week contraceptive pill "Saheli") and *Gugulipid*. - **Indian Institute of Toxicology Research (IITR)** (est. 1965): Environmental health, industrial safety, and toxicology testing. - **National Botanical Research Institute (NBRI)** (est. 1953): Floriculture, plant taxonomy, and germplasm

conservation. - **Birbal Sahni Institute of Palaeosciences (BSIP)** (est. 1946): Dedicated to palaeobotany, plant fossils, and radiometric dating. - **National Bureau of Fish Genetic Resources (NBFGR)** (est. 1983): Aquatic biodiversity conservation.

Bilingual Terminology -- UP Society and Social Issues

English	Hindi	Key Anchor
Social Justice	सामाजिक न्याय	Equitable distribution of rights and opportunities
OBC Reservation	अन्य पिछड़ा वर्ग आरक्षण	27% central; UP OBC reservation = 27%
SC Reservation	अनुसूचित जाति आरक्षण	21% in UP government services
ST Reservation	अनुसूचित जनजाति आरक्षण	2% in UP (limited ST population)
Gender Ratio	लिंग अनुपात	UP sex ratio = 912 (2011) -- below national 943
Beti Bachao Beti Padhao	बेटी बचाओ बेटी पढ़ाओ	Scheme to improve sex ratio and female literacy
Mid-Day Meal	मध्याह्न भोजन	School lunch programme under National Food Security Act
Right to Education	शिक्षा का अधिकार	RTE Act 2009 (Article 21A); free education 6-14 years
Samagra Shiksha	समग्र शिक्षा	Merged SSA + RMSA + TE scheme (2018)
Anganwadi	आँगनवाड़ी	ICDS centre for pre-school nutrition and care
ICDS	समेकित बाल विकास सेवाएँ	Integrated Child Development Services
Child Labour	बाल श्रम	Employment of children under 14 years; Child Labour Act 1986
Dowry	दहेज	Illegal under Dowry Prohibition Act, 1961
Dalit	दलित	SC communities; often used to describe marginalised identity
ASHA	आशा (Accredited Social Health Activist)	Community health worker under NHM

Extended Theory -- UP's Social Profile

Education in UP (Census 2011)

Indicator	UP (2011)	India (2011)
Overall Literacy Rate	67.7%	73.0%

Indicator	UP (2011)	India (2011)
Male Literacy	77.3%	80.9%
Female Literacy	57.2%	64.6%
Gender Literacy Gap	20.1%	16.3%
Highest Literacy District	Gautam Buddha Nagar (80.12%)	Kerala (94.0%) -- State
Lowest Literacy District	Shravasti (46.74%)	Bihar (61.8%) -- State

Key Social Welfare Schemes in UP

Scheme	Purpose	Year
UP CM Bal Seva Yojana	Aid to children who lost parents to COVID-19	2021
Kanya Sumangala Yojana	Financial support to girl child at 6 life stages	2019
UP Vriddha Pension	Old-age pension for senior citizens	Ongoing
Beti Bachao Beti Padhao	Sex ratio improvement and girl education	2015 (national)
Mukhyamantri Abhyudaya Yojana	Free coaching for competitive exams (IAS, NEET, etc.)	2021
Mission Shakti	Women safety and empowerment	2020
UP Free Smartphone/Tablet	Digital access for youth	2021

One-Liner Revision -- UP Society and Education

#	Fast Fact
1	UP literacy rate (2011) = **67.7%** (M: 77.3%, F: 57.2%)
2	UP gender literacy gap = **20.1%** (higher than national 16.3%)
3	Lowest literacy district in UP = **Shravasti (46.74%)**
4	Highest literacy district in UP = **Gautam Buddha Nagar (80.12%)**
5	Lowest female literacy in UP = **Shravasti (34.78%)**
6	UP sex ratio (2011) = **912** (below national 943)
7	UP child sex ratio (2011) = **902** (below national 919)
8	UP SC population = **20.70%** of UP (4.14 Crore -- largest in India)
9	RTE Act 2009 = free education for **6-14 years** (Article 21A)
10	ICDS = pre-school nutrition via **Anganwadi** centres
11	ASHA = Accredited Social Health Activist (NHM frontline worker)

#	Fast Fact
12	Kanya Sumangala Yojana (2019) = Rs 15,000 in **6 life stages**
13	Mission Shakti (2020) = UP women safety campaign
14	Mukhyamantri Abhyudaya Yojana (2021) = free exam coaching
15	Samagra Shiksha (2018) = merged SSA + RMSA + TE